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ATLANTA MARCH 16 - 20, 2026

Capacity Charging Scenarios

How Fabric Determines Capacity Charges

Compute-Based Charging

Charges are based on where compute execution occurs, not data location or user interaction

Capacity Units and Engines

Fabric capacities pool compute resources measured in Capacity Units consumed by each workload

Multi-Workspace Cost Governance

Separate workspaces and capacities isolate workloads, manage noisy neighbors, and align costs with business units

Capacity Follows Compute Rule

Design architectures based on the rule that capacity follows compute to ensure cost predictability and efficient scaling.

Scenario 1 – Power BI Reports and Semantic Models

Compute Load Distribution

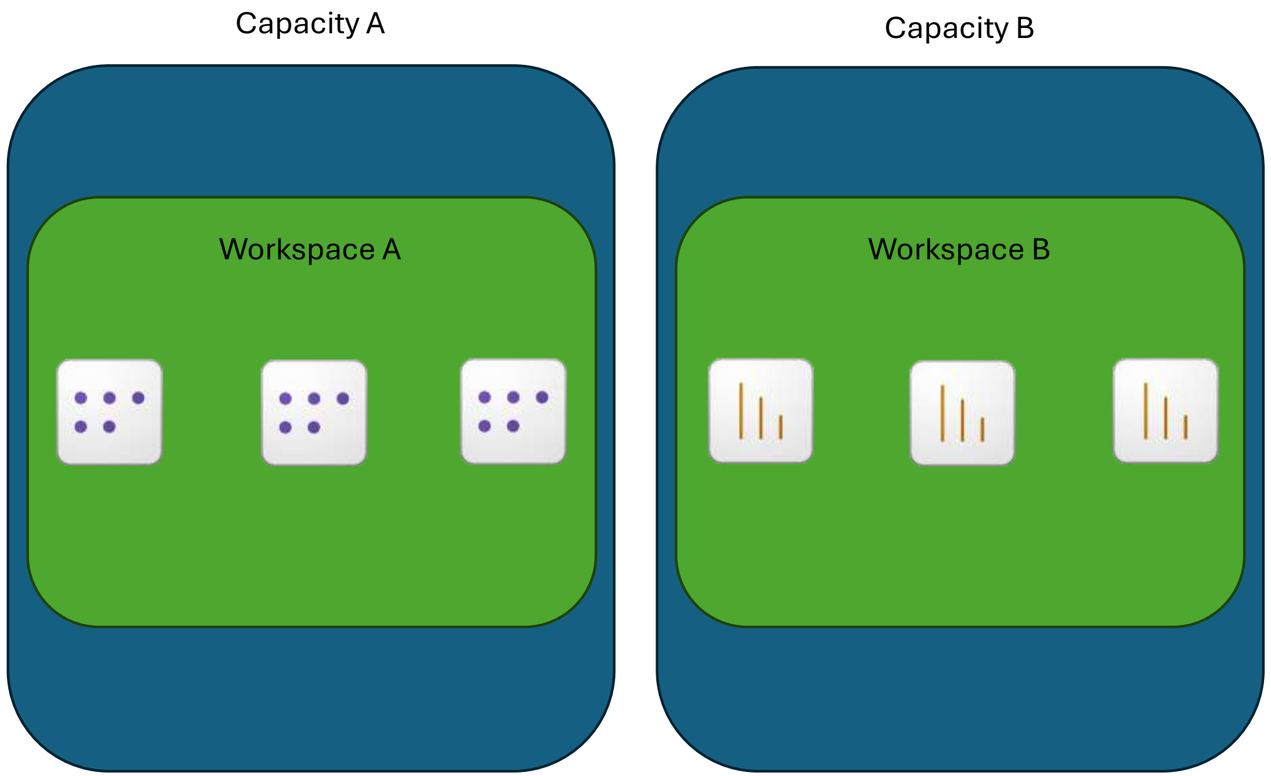
Capacity A handles most compute from DAX queries, while Capacity B manages lightweight report tasks.

Operational Impact

Increased user traffic raises utilization on Capacity A more than Capacity B.

Design and Scaling

Centralizing heavy compute on semantic models enables efficient reuse and requires capacity monitoring for scaling.



Scenario 2 - Shortcuts

Shortcut References

Workspace A contains a Lakehouse with shortcuts referencing data in Workspace B without duplicating storage.

Query Execution Separation

Queries run in Workspace A using its own Spark or SQL engine, separate from where data physically resides.

Billing Responsibility

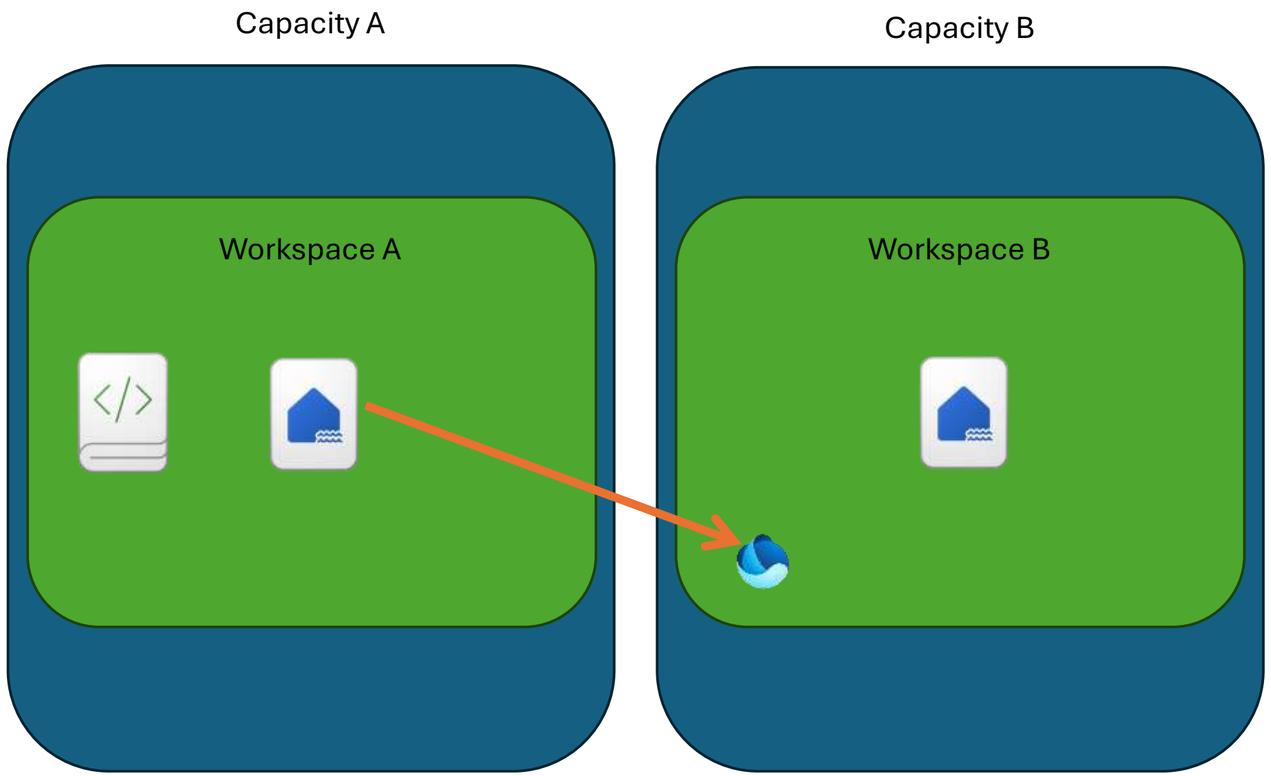
Queries on shortcut data are billed to the consuming workspace's capacity, not the data owner's.

Resource Consumption

Spark and SQL engines in the consuming workspace use CPU, memory, and I/O during query execution.

Cost Allocation Benefits

This model allows fair compute cost allocation and enables independent scaling for consuming teams.



Why Chargeback App in Fabric

- Capacity follows compute
  - The place where the execution occurs gets charged
- Shared capacities model
  - Capacities may by used across teams and users
  - Need a way to see what users and teams are consuming the most capacity
- Easier and more practical to attribute usage than splitting capacities for every group/project

Capacity Chargeback in Fabric

- Split capacities by company groups
  - Business unit, project, etc.
- Fabric Chargeback app
  - Helps understand which teams/users/workloads are driving capacity usage
  - Allocate cost based on consumption
  - Built for capacity admins
  - Consumption is computed as **a percentage of total used on a capacity**
  - It **does not** incorporate the “actual dollar cost” directly from Azure cost data; instead, it provides **usage fractions** you apply to your cost management numbers

Fabric Chargeback App Pages

- Overview Page
  - **Workspace / Item / Domain & Subdomain utilization** (percent of capacity utilization by each grouping)
  - **Utilization (CU) by date** (daily utilization trend)
  - **Utilization details matrix** including user details and breakdown by user
- Drill-through
  - Right-click drill-through to: **Workspace details**
  - **Item details**
  - **Domain details**
- Export Functionality

Fabric Chargeback App Nuances

- Specialized consumption – doesn't map cleanly to a workspaces or item.
  - VNET Gateways
  - Copilot
- Items and workspaces with no domain associated will roll up under "No domain/subdomain"
- It is in public preview
- Data is not in real time
  - Daily refresh
- Install in a workspace that is licensed for Pro or on an admin capacity
  - Avoid throttling due to overutilization

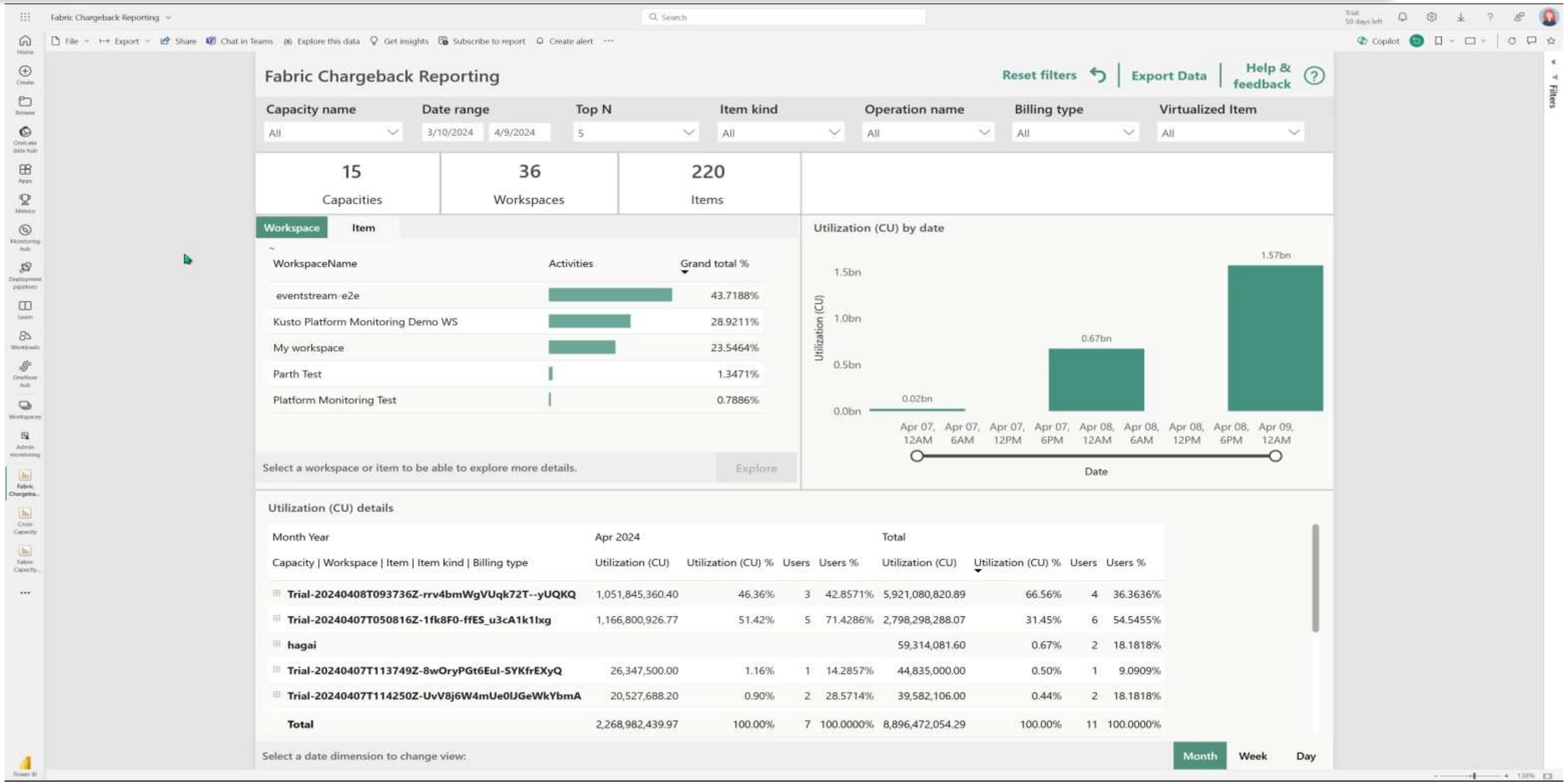
Recap

- **3 use cases:**
  - **Monthly internal chargeback**: Use usage % per workspace/item/user and apply finance's cost model (since dollars aren't embedded)
  - **Capacity optimization**: identify expensive workspaces/items and drive remediation (scale/relocate/optimize)
  - **Governance transparency**: share the report with BU owners to reduce "surprise bills" and make consumption visible
- **Forward-looking note (optional):**
  - Chargeback capabilities are expected to be incorporated into the **Capacity Metrics App**, with the "standalone" chargeback app being retired as a standalone app per internal tracking.

Fabric Capacity Chargeback App

Capacity Management

Chargeback



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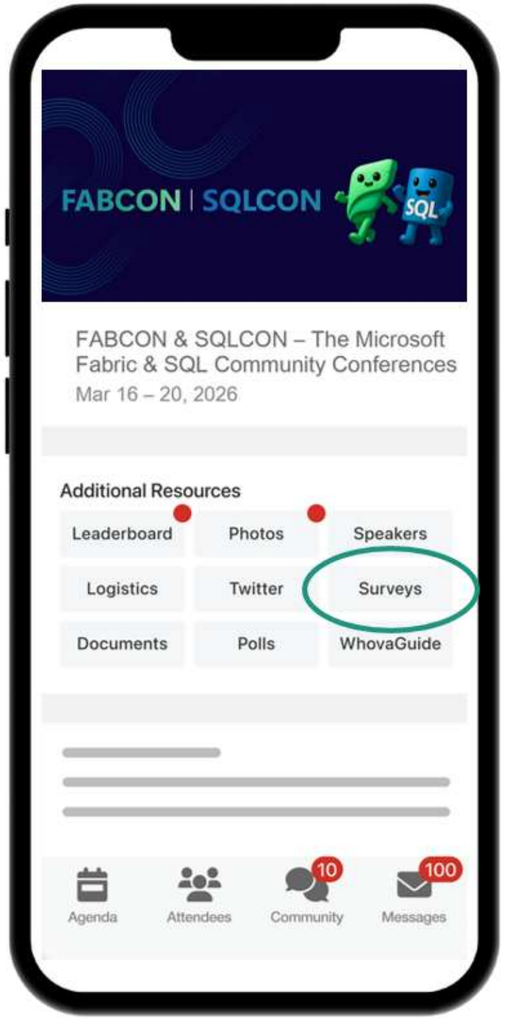

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